

ENGAGEMENT SURVEY

NEXT STEPS

SEPTEMBER 2023



ASBURY *theological*
SEMINARY

THANKING GOD FOR THE PAST, TRUSTING GOD FOR THE FUTURE

April	May	June	July	August	September
Share Survey Results	Discovery Groups	Discovery Groups	Cross Functional Team	Cross Functional Team	Share Action Plan Steps
		Summarize Feedback	Action Planning	Action Planning	Begin implementation
		Cross Functional Team to review themes and identify next step actions		August 6 Cabinet Retreat	
				August 10 Meeting	

- F** = Fantastic Teams
- L** = Life-Giving Work
- O** = Outstanding Talent
- U** = Uplifting Growth
- R** = Rewarding Compensation
- I** = Inspirational Leadership
- S** = Sustainable Strategy
- H** = Healthy Communication

Organization	Overall
Asbury Theological Seminary	3.57
Sector Average	3.89



What is a Discovery Group?

- ▶ Opportunity to **discuss and process** the survey results in smaller settings
- ▶ The insights, perspectives, and questions **give context to the quantitative data**
- ▶ The results **help build** the action plan
- ▶ Opportunity to **hear and learn** from other Asbury Theological Seminary colleagues

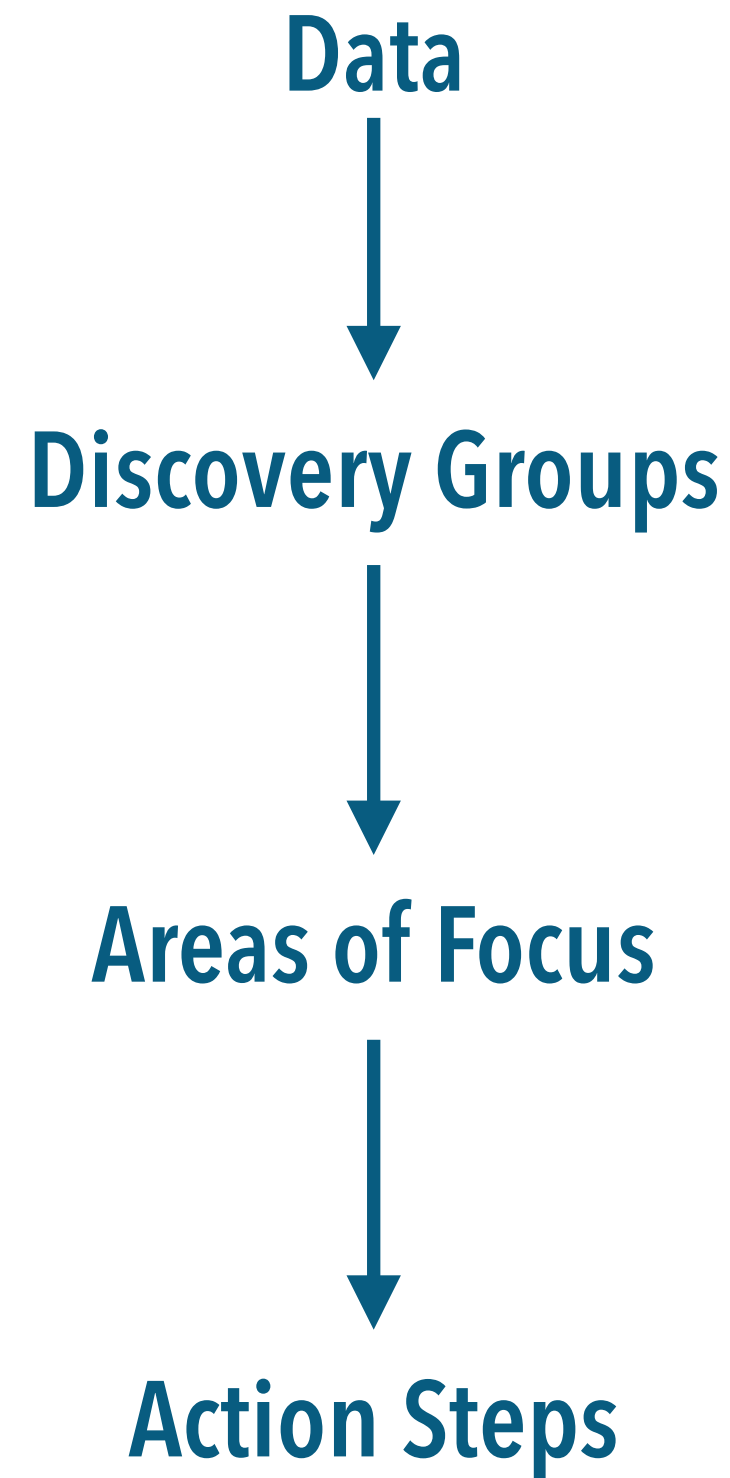
What happens in a Discovery Group?

- ▶ **Brief review** of the overall survey results
- ▶ A series of **appreciative inquiry questions**
- ▶ Appreciative inquiry is a process that supports a **positive approach to enhancing organizational performance**

The 7 Questions

1. How will we lead?
2. Who are we as a team?
3. How will we work through conflict?
4. How will we make decisions?
5. How will we communicate?
6. How will we hold each other accountable?
7. What are the most important things we should be working on?

- Andrew McFarland
- Chris Kiesling
- Ellen Marmon
- Jay Mansur
- Maria Kenney
- Matt Barnes
- Medine Keener
- Paula Hisel
- Robin Ferraro
- Sadie Sasser
- Tammy Cessna
- Tracey Farrell
- Variee VanLaningham



Why & How

This focuses on clarifying the purpose and goals of Asbury Seminary, engaging the entire staff, faculty, and administrators in determining effective strategies to achieve these objectives. It acknowledges the potential for organizations to have mission drift and emphasizes the need for intentional awareness when this may be happening.

- 1. Department Shares:** Provide opportunities to familiarize ourselves with the structure, purpose, and objectives of every Asbury department to foster greater levels of collaboration and understanding.
- 2. Reenvisioning Experience:** Develop a reenvisioning experience that reminds and envisions us about Asbury's vision, values, and history.
- 3. Strategic Plan:** Revisit the strategic plan to clarify understanding, make adjustments if necessary, and define implementation steps.
- 4. Workforce Analysis:** Conduct a workforce analysis to understand the level of support and resources required to accomplish the strategic plan.

Decision-Making

This seeks to improve decision-making processes at the seminary. It examines power dynamics, communication channels, collaboration, and the establishment of safe forums for addressing concerns.

- 1. Cabinet Functioning:** Examine current patterns of leadership and identify next step actions that will strengthen how they work together and how they provide leadership to Asbury. *Note: The Cabinet includes the President and Vice-Presidents.*
- 2. Cascading Communication:** Establish a cascading communication process, enabling the Cabinet to promptly relay meeting outcomes and decisions to departments that fosters two-way interaction.
- 3. Definitions:** Clarify the meanings of shared governance and accreditation and their relevance to decision-making in our daily work.
- 4. Decision-Making Guidelines:** Specify decision-making guidelines for the various Asbury teams and committees. Included is an operational plan to ensure decisions are made considering their impact on others.

A Working Community

This envisions a strong and interconnected community at Asbury Seminary, where people are prioritized and feel like they belong. Positive relationships are fostered between different departments and members of the administration, faculty, schools, and staff. It emphasizes preserving individual identities, empowering members, respecting differences, and valuing truth, gratitude, and promise-keeping, while seeking to resolve conflicts fairly and build trust.

- 1. Asbury Global:** Integrate and involve Asbury Global in a way that results in a greater sense of connection to the overall mission.
- 2. Connection Opportunities:** Create connection points for the purpose of building and developing relationships across schools, departments, and extension sites.
- 3. Teamwork:** Define how we'll foster cross school, department, and extension site teamwork and communicate in a healthy way.

Truth Telling

This highlights the importance of truthful and transparent communication. It aims to foster a culture where both positive and hard information is shared, and genuine truth-telling is practiced, promoting clarity, vulnerability, and openness.

- 1. Transparency:** Increase the level of transparency including how information is presented, multiplicity of voices, understanding of department budgets, and the sharing of information with and from the Board.
- 2. Raising Concerns:** Develop and implement protocols that clearly outline how concerns can be raised and how they'll be addressed.

Employee Retention

This recognizes and appreciates the significance of every member in the Asbury Seminary working community, with a focus on employee retention. It aims to achieve this by offering fair compensation, including pay and benefits like insurance and leave policies, fostering a commitment to continuous professional development, and actively listening to and recognizing employee concerns, ideas, achievements, and growth opportunities.

- 1. Compensation and Benefits:** Reassess, clarify, and communicate Asbury's compensation and benefits philosophy.
- 2. Leave Policies:** Review and update the following leave policies: maternity, paternity, family, and mission.
- 3. Professional Development:** Implement a developmental framework that encourages and equips each team member to take a next step in their professional growth.

Spiritual Formation/Sanctification

This is rooted in Asbury's commitment to sending out sanctified individuals. It focuses on engaging staff, faculty, and administration in an ongoing journey of spiritual formation seeking holiness and spiritual transformation.

- 1. Spiritual Journey:** Design a spiritual healing and renewal experience for the Asbury community. Included is a rethinking of the chapel strategy.
- 2. Pastoral Care:** Provide seminary-funded pastoral care sessions for faculty and staff.
- 3. Spiritual Leadership:** Equip those in leadership positions in the *First Loved* content.

- ▶ Prioritization exercise and discussion
- ▶ What should we prioritize between now and December 31 that will get us the most momentum and positive movement?
- ▶ This resulted in 8 actions
- ▶ A similar exercise will occur for the spring semester

IMPLEMENTATION: GETTING STARTED WITH 8 ACTIONS

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Area of Focus	Action
Why and How	
Decision-Making	Cabinet Functioning: Examine current patterns of leadership and identify next step actions that will strengthen how they work together and how they provide leadership to Asbury. <i>Note: The Cabinet includes the President and Vice-Presidents.</i> Cascading Communication: Establish a cascading communication process, enabling the Cabinet to promptly relay meeting outcomes and decisions to departments that fosters two-way interaction.
A Working Community	Connection Opportunities: Create connection points for the purpose of building and developing relationships across schools, departments, and extension sites. Teamwork: Define how we'll foster cross school, department, and extension site teamwork and communicate in a healthy way.
Truth Telling	Transparency: Increase the level of transparency including how information is presented, multiplicity of voices, understanding of department budgets, and the sharing of information with and from the Board.
Employee Retention	Compensation and Benefits: Reassess, clarify, and communicate Asbury's compensation and benefits philosophy. Leave Policies: Review and update the following leave policies: maternity, paternity, family, and mission.
Spiritual Formation/Sanctification	Spiritual Journey: Design a spiritual healing and renewal experience for the Asbury community. Included is a rethinking of the chapel strategy.

- **Cabinet:** Ensure that an action plan is created and implemented.
- **Project Teams:** Responsible for developing and executing a project plan for each action plan item.

IMPLEMENTATION: GETTING STARTED WITH 8 ACTIONS

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Area of Focus	Action
Why and How	
Decision-Making	Cabinet Functioning: Examine current patterns of leadership and identify next step actions that will strengthen how they work together and how they provide leadership to Asbury. <i>Note: The Cabinet includes the President and Vice-Presidents.</i> [Executive Committee of the Board] Cascading Communication: Establish a cascading communication process, enabling the Cabinet to promptly relay meeting outcomes and decisions to departments that fosters two-way interaction. [Cabinet]
A Working Community	Connection Opportunities: Create connection points for the purpose of building and developing relationships across schools, departments, and extension sites. [Project Team] Teamwork: Define how we'll foster cross school, department, and extension site teamwork and communicate in a healthy way. [Project Team]
Truth Telling	Transparency: Increase the level of transparency including how information is presented, multiplicity of voices, understanding of department budgets, and the sharing of information with and from the Board. [Cabinet & President's Council]
Employee Retention	Compensation and Benefits: Reassess, clarify, and communicate Asbury's compensation and benefits philosophy. [Cabinet & Project Team] Leave Policies: Review and update the following leave policies: maternity, paternity, family, and mission. [Cabinet & Project Team]
Spiritual Formation/Sanctification	Spiritual Journey: Design a spiritual healing and renewal experience for the Asbury community. Included is a rethinking of the chapel strategy. [Student Learning and Formation Committee and Formation Team]

Discussion Questions

- ▶ What did you resonate with?
- ▶ What questions do you have?
- ▶ What concerns do you have?
- ▶ What can our school, department, or extension site do to contribute to the successful completion of these actions?
- ▶ Is there anything independent of these actions that our department, school, or extension site needs to focus on to strengthen our team dynamics?

Q&A

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